



SERVICES PROVIDED

Architects

PROJECT TYPE

Masterplanning / Residential

LOCATION

Nairobi, Kenya

YEAR

1982

The multi award winning Lake View Estate.....

This unique residential development set in a fully landscaped, well-maintained, secure, and competently engineered estate, with carefully considered land use has become a milestone in excellence in residential development in Nairobi. The lake has become a major landmark in Nairobi, and the entire area around Lakeview Estate has collectively come to be known as Lakeview.

Emanating from an architectural competition in the late 1970's, this winning design set to develop 60 acres of abandoned coffee plantation with three low-lying swampy areas into a residential community. PLANNING recognized the unique opportunity available for creation of a lake in a large vlei in the centre of the site, and with this the financial advantages of not bringing in vast quantities of earth to fill it as was proposed by other architects.

The outline designs from PLANNING for 88, 4-bedroomed, 2.5 bath roomed houses on 60 acres were regarded as "untested" and there were initial doubts about sales. The lake was designed to be self-cleansing with carefully selected water-purifying plants and fish that would control mosquito larvae, frogs, and algae. Many exceptionally mature trees would be protected. A botanical study of the site identified 2 ground creepers new to the Herbarium and a species of eucalyptus tree not known of elsewhere in East Africa. The materials and design of the typical house type came from an intense study by PLANNING of the most cost-effective yet sustainable materials to use. The combination of "dry stone" for the external walls, brick, cedar wood block floors and timber columns, beams and sloped wood strip finishes under clay tile roofs (no ceilings) gave these houses a unique appeal, and they sold fast.

